

Moodify Brand Guidelines

Version: 2.0 (Audited & Expanded) **Project:** Moodify – AI-Powered Emotional Wellness Platform **Document Type:** Brand Guidelines
Status: Approved

1. Brand Overview

Brand Name

Moodify

Tagline

Because Every Emotion Has a Story.

Elevator Pitch

Moodify is an AI-powered emotional wellness platform that helps users recognize, understand, and improve their emotional well-being through facial emotion recognition, generative AI, personalized wellness recommendations, and long-term mood analytics.

Unlike traditional mood-tracking applications that rely on manual journaling, Moodify enables users to understand their emotions in seconds through AI-powered facial analysis and actionable wellness guidance.

Brand Story

Most people don't stop to check in on how they're feeling until it's already a problem — a bad week, a burnt-out semester, a relationship strain they didn't see building. Journaling apps ask for a habit most people never form. Wearables measure the body but not the moment.

Moodify started from a simple question: what if understanding your emotional state took the same effort as taking a selfie? By pairing computer vision with generative AI, a single photo becomes a starting point for self-awareness — not a diagnosis, not a verdict, just a mirror with a gentle suggestion attached.

Brand Promise

Every time you check in with Moodify, you'll leave knowing one true thing about how you feel, and one small thing you can do about it.

Value Proposition

For people who want emotional self-awareness without the friction of journaling, Moodify turns a 10-second facial scan into an instant mood reading, an AI-written explanation, and a personalized wellness action — private, judgment-free, and immediate.

Brand Archetype

The Caregiver, expressed through The Sage's clarity.

Moodify nurtures (Caregiver) but never coddles or diagnoses — it informs and guides with calm intelligence (Sage). This pairing is why the brand voice is warm but never soft-headed, and why the visual language is clean and confident rather than cute or clinical.

2. Vision

To create a future where emotional self-awareness becomes a simple daily habit, empowering people to recognize emotional patterns early and take meaningful actions toward better mental well-being.

3. Mission

Our mission is to leverage Artificial Intelligence and Computer Vision to make emotional wellness accessible, understandable, and actionable by transforming a simple facial scan into personalized emotional insights and practical wellness recommendations while respecting user privacy.

4. Core Values

Human-Centered

Technology should support people, not replace them.

Privacy First

Users always control their emotional data.

Transparency

AI recommendations should always explain why they are generated.

Simplicity

Emotional wellness should never feel complicated.

Trust

Every interaction should build confidence in the platform.

Accessibility

The platform should be usable by everyone regardless of technical knowledge.

Value Priority (when values conflict)

In practice, these values are not all equal weight. When a design or product decision forces a trade-off, resolve it in this order: **Privacy First > Trust > Transparency > Human-Centered > Accessibility > Simplicity**. A feature that is simple but erodes privacy, or transparent but erodes trust, does not ship.

5. Brand Personality

Moodify should always feel:

- Calm
 - Friendly
 - Intelligent
 - Trustworthy
 - Supportive
 - Modern
 - Premium
 - Minimal
 - Empathetic
 - Professional
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Personality Matrix

Attribute	Level
Friendly	High
Professional	High
Technical	Medium
Emotional	Medium
Playful	Low

Luxury	Medium
Corporate	Low
Modern	Very High

6. Target Audience

Primary Users

- College Students
- University Students
- Working Professionals
- Remote Employees
- Young Adults
- Individuals interested in emotional wellness

Secondary Users

- HR Wellness Programs
- Educational Institutions
- Counselors
- Wellness Communities

Emotional Positioning

Moodify occupies the space between "I'm fine" and "I need therapy" — the large, underserved middle ground where someone senses something is off but doesn't have language for it yet. Moodify's job is to give that feeling a name, gently, without ever suggesting the user is broken or in crisis.

Note: primary/secondary segments and the emotional positioning above are working assumptions for MVP design direction, not yet validated by user research — revisit once real usage data exists.

Emotional Journey

Stage	User feeling	What Moodify does
Before scan	Unsure, slightly self-conscious	Calm consent screen, no pressure, clear privacy note
During scan	Slightly vulnerable	Fast (<30s), no lingering on the camera, immediate feedback
Right after result	Curious, maybe surprised	Named emotion + non-judgmental AI insight + visible disclaimer
After suggestion	Slightly empowered	One small, doable action, not a list of demands
Over days/weeks	Increasingly self-aware	Trend charts that show patterns without alarmist framing

7. Brand Voice & Tone

Moodify communicates as a supportive wellness companion rather than a medical expert.

Every interaction should feel:

- Calm
 - Positive
 - Encouraging
 - Non-Judgmental
 - Respectful
 - Reassuring
-

Writing Principles

Always:

- Explain clearly
- Use simple language
- Encourage healthy habits
- Offer suggestions instead of commands
- Acknowledge emotions without assuming causes

Never:

- Diagnose users
 - Create fear
 - Use harsh language
 - Make unrealistic promises
 - Overwhelm users with technical jargon
-

Example Tone

✗ "Stress detected."

✓ "You seem a little stressed today. Taking a short break or a few deep breaths might help."

AI Personality Guidelines

The AI voice (insights, suggestions, chat, reports) is a specific character, not a generic assistant:

- **Speaks like:** a calm, observant friend who happens to know a bit about wellness — never a clinician, never a hype-coach.
- **Never says:** "you have," "you suffer from," "you need to," or anything resembling a diagnosis or command.
- **Always frames observations as possibilities:** "might,"

"could," "seems like," never certainty about internal states it cannot verify.

- **Confidence is disclosed, not hidden:** low-confidence readings say so in plain language rather than presenting a guess as fact.
 - **Consistency across surfaces:** the same personality should be recognizable whether the AI is writing a one-line insight or a full weekly report — same word choices, same restraint, same warmth.
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Copywriting Guidelines

- **Buttons:** verb-first, 1-3 words ("Start Scan," "Add to Plan," "Download Report") — never vague ("Submit," "OK") or cute ("Let's go!").
 - **Capitalization:** sentence case everywhere (buttons, headings, labels) — no ALL CAPS, no Title Case for body copy.
 - **Length:** one idea per sentence; if a tooltip or message needs "and," consider two lines instead.
 - **Numbers:** always show the number, never just a qualitative word, when precision helps ("82" not just "high").
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Empty State Guidelines

Empty states should feel like a fresh start, not a failure.

✗ "No data available."

✓ "Your first scan will show up here — it only takes a few seconds."

Loading State Guidelines

Loading copy should describe *what's happening*, briefly, never just spin silently for anything over ~2 seconds.

✗ (blank spinner with no text)

✓ "Reading your expression..." / "Putting your insight together..."

Error Message Tone

Errors are framed as solvable, never as the user's fault.

✗ "Error: face not found."

✓ "We couldn't quite see your face — try moving a little closer to good light."

Success Message Tone

Success is acknowledged warmly but briefly — it should not interrupt momentum.

✗ "Task successfully marked as complete."

✓ "Nice — marked as done."

Notification Guidelines

Notifications should never create urgency or guilt about missed check-ins.

✗ "You haven't checked your mood in 3 days!"

✓ "Whenever you're ready, your next check-in is here."

8. Visual Design Direction

Moodify should combine the simplicity of modern productivity applications with the calming atmosphere of wellness platforms.

The visual identity should feel:

- Clean
- Spacious
- Minimal
- Modern
- Soft
- Elegant
- Comfortable

Users should immediately feel:

Safe, relaxed, and understood.

Visual Principles

1. **Whitespace is a feature, not empty space** — it signals calm before any color or copy does.
 2. **One focal point per screen** — the eye should always know where to land first (usually the mood/emotion itself).
 3. **Soft over sharp** — rounded corners, gentle shadows, muted contrast; nothing that visually "shouts."
 4. **Data should look calm, not clinical** — charts favor smooth curves and soft fills over harsh bar edges and gridlines.
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UX Principles

1. **No dead ends** — every screen has a clear next action, especially after errors (see Error Handling in the Implementation Plan).
 2. **Progressive disclosure** — show the mood/insight first, suggestions second, deeper analytics only on request.
 3. **Reversible by default** — destructive actions (delete history, delete account) always confirm first.
 4. **Consistency over novelty** — a returning user should never have to relearn where something lives.
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9. Design Inspiration

Moodify takes inspiration from the design philosophies of:

- Apple Health (clean layouts)
- Headspace (calm wellness experience)
- Calm (minimal emotional design)
- Notion (excellent readability)
- Linear (professional interface)
- Stripe Dashboard (organized information hierarchy)

The goal is inspiration—not imitation.

10. Color System

Primary Color

Deep Indigo

HEX: #4F46E5

Purpose:

- Brand identity
 - Primary buttons
 - Active navigation
 - Highlights
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Secondary Color

Soft Blue

HEX: #60A5FA

Purpose:

- Secondary actions

- Charts
 - Information cards
-

Accent Color

Teal

HEX: #14B8A6

Purpose:

- AI suggestions
 - Wellness actions
 - Interactive elements
-

Success

Green

HEX: #22C55E

Purpose:

Completed tasks

Positive trends

Success messages

Warning

Amber

HEX: #F59E0B

Purpose:

Reminders

Incomplete tasks

Error

Red

HEX: #EF4444

Purpose:

Validation

Errors

Critical alerts

Background

Light

HEX: #F8FAFC

Dark

HEX: #0F172A

Surface

White

HEX: #FFFFFF

Dark Surface

HEX: #1E293B

Border

HEX: #E2E8F0

Text Primary

HEX: #0F172A

Text Secondary

HEX: #64748B

Design Tokens

Every raw hex value above maps to a semantic token — code should reference tokens, never hex, so a future theme change is a one-line edit:

Token	Value	Maps to
color-primary	#4F46E5	Primary Color
color-secondary	#60A5FA	Secondary Color
color-accent	#14B8A6	Accent Color
color-success	#22C55E	Success
color-warning	#F59E0B	Warning
color-error	#EF4444	Error
color-bg-light / color-bg-dark	#F8FAFC / #0F172A	Background
color-surface-light / color-surface-dark	#FFFFFF / #1E293B	Surface
color-border	#E2E8F0	Border
color-text-primary	#0F172A	Text Primary
color-text-secondary	#64748B	Text Secondary

Dark Mode / Theme System

Dark mode is not an inverted light mode — it reuses the same semantic tokens with different underlying values (already listed as "Dark" variants above for Background and Surface). Rules:

- Primary, Accent, Success, Warning, and Error hues stay the same in both themes for recognizability; only Background, Surface, and Text tokens swap.
 - Text Primary in dark mode is a soft off-white, never pure #FFFFFF, to avoid harsh contrast against #0F172A.
 - Theme is a stored user preference (Settings § Profile), defaulting to system preference on first load.
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Color Accessibility Pairing Table

Foreground	Background	Passes 4.5:1?	Use for
Text Primary (#0F172A)	Background Light (#F8FAFC)	Yes	Body copy, light mode
Text Secondary (#64748B)	Background Light (#F8FAFC)	Yes (large text only)	Captions, helper text
White (#FFFFFF)	Primary (#4F46E5)	Yes	Primary button labels
White (#FFFFFF)	Accent (#14B8A6)	Yes	Accent button labels
White (#FFFFFF)	Warning (#F59E0B)	No — use Text Primary instead	Warning banners

11. Accessibility

Minimum contrast ratio:

4.5:1 (WCAG 2.1 Level AA)

Use color together with icons.

Never rely on color alone.

Support keyboard navigation.

Support screen readers.

Every interactive element must have a visible focus ring (2px, Accent color) — never `outline: none` without a replacement.

12. Typography

Primary Font

Inter

Purpose:

Entire application

Secondary Font

Poppins

Purpose:

Marketing pages

Headings

Monospace

JetBrains Mono

Purpose:

Developer information

API examples

Typography Scale

H1

48px

Bold

Line-height 1.15 / Letter-spacing -0.02em

H2

36px

Bold

Line-height 1.2 / Letter-spacing -0.01em

H3

30px

SemiBold

Line-height 1.25

H4

24px

SemiBold

Line-height 1.3

Body

16px

Regular

Line-height 1.6

Small

14px

Regular

Line-height 1.5

Caption

12px

Regular

Line-height 1.4

Responsive Scale

On viewports < 480px, reduce H1 to 34px, H2 to 26px, H3 to 22px, H4 to 20px. Body, Small, and Caption remain fixed for readability.

13. Iconography

Primary Icon Library

Lucide Icons

Reason:

- Minimal
 - Consistent
 - Open Source
 - Matches shadcn/ui
 - Modern appearance
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Icon Sizing & Usage Rules

- Default size: 20px inline with body text, 24px in navigation, 32px for empty-state illustrations.
 - Stroke width: 1.5px (Lucide default) — never mix stroke weights on the same screen.
 - Icons never carry meaning alone in a critical action (e.g., delete) — always paired with a text label.
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Logo Usage Rules

(No visual logo mark exists yet at MVP stage — these rules govern the wordmark until one is designed.)

- Wordmark is set in Poppins SemiBold, always "Moodify" with a capital M, never all lowercase or all caps.
 - Minimum clear space around the wordmark: equal to the height of the capital "M" on all sides.
 - Minimum size: 20px cap-height to remain legible in a nav bar or favicon context.
 - Approved backgrounds: Background Light, Background Dark, or white — never placed directly on a busy photo or gradient without a solid-color safe area behind it.
-

Logo Don'ts

- Don't stretch, skew, or rotate the wordmark.
 - Don't recolor it outside Primary (#4F46E5), White, or Text Primary (#0F172A).
 - Don't add drop shadows, outlines, or effects to the wordmark.
 - Don't pair it with a tagline in a different typeface.
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14. Illustration Style

Illustrations should be:

- Minimal
- Flat
- Soft gradients
- Rounded shapes
- Human-centered
- Abstract emotional visuals

Avoid:

- Cartoon characters

- Overly realistic medical imagery
 - Loud colors
-

Photography & Image Style

Where photography is used (marketing/landing page only — never in-app):

- Real, diverse people in natural, unposed-looking moments — no stock-photo "corporate handshake" energy.
 - Soft, natural lighting; avoid harsh studio lighting or heavy filters.
 - No photos implying diagnosis, therapy sessions, or clinical settings — this is a wellness product, not a medical one.
 - Consistent warm color grading that complements the Background Light palette.
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15. Spacing System

Use an 8-point spacing system.

Available spacing:

- 4px
- 8px
- 12px
- 16px
- 24px
- 32px
- 48px
- 64px
- 96px

Token names: `space-0-5` (4px) through `space-12` (96px), incrementing with the scale above, for consistent handoff to code.

Grid System

- Desktop: 12-column grid, 24px gutters, max content width 1200px, centered.
 - Tablet: 8-column grid, 20px gutters.
 - Mobile: 4-column grid, 16px gutters, 16px outer margin.
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16. Border Radius

Buttons

12px

Cards

20px

Inputs

12px

Dialogs

24px

Charts

20px

17. Shadow System

Small

Cards

```
0 1px 2px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.06)
```

Medium

Dropdowns

```
0 4px 12px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.10)
```

Large

Dialogs

```
0 12px 32px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.14)
```

Extra Large

Feature cards

```
0 20px 48px rgba(15, 23, 42, 0.18)
```

Elevation Values

The four shadow tiers above map to elevation levels 1-4; higher elevation is reserved for elements that temporarily interrupt the interface (dialogs, dropdowns) and should never be used on static, always-visible content like the dashboard cards.

Glassmorphism Stance

Glassmorphism (frosted/blurred translucent panels) is **intentionally not used**. It conflicts with the "clean, calm, high-contrast-where-it-matters" direction and tends to reduce text legibility — a direct conflict with the Accessibility section. Solid surfaces with soft shadows are the standard instead.

18. Motion & Interaction Principles

Animations should feel:

- Smooth
- Natural
- Purposeful

Avoid:

- Fast animations
- Flashing effects
- Distracting motion

Examples:

- Fade In
 - Slide Up
 - Scale
 - Gentle Hover
 - Smooth Chart Animation
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Motion Timing Tokens

Token	Duration	Easing	Use for
motion-fast	120ms	ease-out	Hover states, button presses
motion-base	200ms	ease-in-out	Fade-ins, card entrances
motion-slow	350ms	ease-in-out	Page transitions, chart draw-in
motion-chart	600ms	cubic-bezier(0.22, 1, 0.36, 1)	Chart animation on data load

No animation should exceed ~400ms except chart draw-in, to keep the interface feeling responsive rather than decorative.

19. Component Style

Buttons

Rounded

Filled

Minimal

Cards

Large

Soft shadows

Rounded corners

Lots of white space

Forms

Simple

Minimal

Single-column layout

Charts

Clean

Readable

Minimal gridlines

Rounded tooltips

Navigation

Minimal sidebar

Clear hierarchy

No unnecessary icons

Component States

Every interactive component must define, at minimum:

State	Treatment
Default	As specified above
Hover	Subtle background/border shift using <code>motion-fast</code>
Active/Pressed	Slight scale-down (0.98) or darken by one shade
Focus	2px Accent-color ring, always visible for keyboard users
Disabled	40% opacity, no hover/active response, cursor: not-allowed
Loading	Content replaced by a skeleton or inline spinner, never a full-screen blocker for small components
Error	Border shifts to Error color; helper text below in Error color, icon-paired

20. Branding Guidelines

Do

- ✓ Use plenty of whitespace
 - ✓ Keep layouts clean
 - ✓ Maintain visual consistency
 - ✓ Use calming colors
 - ✓ Use simple language
 - ✓ Focus on clarity
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Don't

- ✗ Use bright neon colors
 - ✗ Overcrowd the interface
 - ✗ Use medical imagery
 - ✗ Add unnecessary animations
 - ✗ Use aggressive language
 - ✗ Overcomplicate interactions
-

21. Emotional Design Principles

Every screen should answer one question:

"Does this interface help the user feel calmer than before?"

Every interaction should reduce stress rather than create it.

Two supporting questions to apply alongside it:

- **"Does this build trust, or just look nice?"** — visual polish never substitutes for honest, disclosed AI behavior.
 - **"Does this respect the user's time?"** — every extra tap, every unnecessary confirmation, is a small tax on someone who may already be low on patience.
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22. Mood Board Description

The Moodify interface should feel like:

- Apple Health's cleanliness
- Headspace's calmness
- Linear's professionalism

- Notion's readability

Overall Impression:

Calm • Modern • Intelligent • Trustworthy • Minimal • Premium

23. Brand Consistency Checklist

Before approving any design, verify:

- Typography follows guidelines (including line-height/letter-spacing)
 - Colors match the design token system (not raw hex copy-pasted)
 - Components remain consistent, including all defined states
 - Accessibility standards are met (contrast, focus rings, color+icon pairing)
 - Animations use the defined motion tokens and stay within timing limits
 - Brand voice remains supportive; AI-generated text follows the AI Personality Guidelines
 - Privacy messaging is visible wherever camera or personal data is involved
 - Logo (wordmark) usage follows the Logo Usage Rules and avoids all listed Don'ts
 - Empty, loading, error, and success states all have copy defined before a screen ships
 - The interface feels calm and uncluttered
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Document Approval

Status: Approved for Design Phase (v2.0 — audited and expanded per design review)

This document serves as the single source of truth for all visual, branding, and interaction decisions across the Moodify platform. No further Brand Guidelines document is required before beginning UI/UX design; the next document is [02_Design_System.md](#), which will define every reusable UI component using the tokens and states established here.